ý tưởng

The Golden Era

Enicar earned a reputation in the mid-20th century for producing high-quality tool watches that combined technical reliability with bold design at prices well below those of luxury competitors such Rolex and Blancpain.

Models like the Sherpa Graph, Sherpa Jet, and Sherpa Super-Dive featured in-house movements, robust EPSA compressor cases, and real-world testing by climbers, racers, and military divers.

Despite this engineering credibility, Enicar remained remarkably affordable, making professional-grade Swiss watches accessible to a wider global audience, especially in Asia, where the brand built a strong following. This value-driven approach helped position Enicar as a brand for doers, not just collectors.

The Big Problem

Enicar was slow to invest in quartz development compared to Japanese and some Swiss rivals, making it vulnerable when consumer demand shifted rapidly in the 1970s. Despite supplying high-performance watches (e.g., Sherpa Dive, Graph), Enicar lacked the marketing clarity and documentation to establish mainstream professional credibility like Rolex or Omega.

After acquired by Wah Ming Hong in 1987, the brand under new ownership did not preserve or invest in the original archives, making it difficult to build continuity with collectors or use historical storytelling in branding. Without clear design direction or mechanical credibility, modern Enicar watches were largely ignored by serious watch communities, further eroding the brand's value in the long term.

RESEARCH QUESTION

How can **archive-based**, **human-factors storytelling** reintroduce Enicar Sherpa to **contemporary audiences** and measurably increase **comprehension, engagement, and purchase intent?**

PROJECT AIM

PREVENT THE BRAND FROM BEING OBSOLETE

AIM JUSTIFICATION

- The design **can't be replicate** by other brands.
- There are still **past customers** and a **loyal fanbase.**
- There are **seasoned watch collectors** who are **opened to learn** about the brand.
- There are brands that are **on the verge of becoming obsolete** that might be benefit from this project.

CONTENTS FOR EXHIBITION

PROMOTION

Social Media Post (Teaser, Countdown, Archive)

Invitation Card (Digital & Physical)

EXHIBITION

Introduction / Concept Wall

Printings of Designs, Archives, Ads, Catalogues

Digital Display of Documentary Footages

Website Including Everything (Project Concept, Design Process, Interactive Timeline, Archive & Sources Folder, Link to Information Sponsor Website, Contact)

RECEPTION

Brochure (Summary of Project, QR to Website)

Brand Postcard

Interest:

Important watch brand but went bankrupted due to industry crisis and new ownership

Problem:

After going bankrupted after the Quartz crisis in the 1987, the brand has become a "zombie" entity under this new ownership, ignoring its rich history of exploration and racing to produce generic, mass-market dress watches that rely on the logo's recognition rather than horological innovation.

On today's market, the brand is often undervalued comparing to its former competitors, despite its significance in the past and the quality of the watches. Mainly because of the lack of storytelling and sharing of knowledge within thr community.

Reserch Question:

How can archive-based, human-factors storytelling reintroduce Enicar Sherpa to contemporary audiences and measurably increase comprehension, engagement, and purchase intent?

Project Aim:

Prevent brand from being obsolete

Why?

- **There are still past customers and a loyal fanbase**
- **There are collectors/enthusiasts who've never heard of the brand and are opened to learn about it**
- **There are similar brands that are on the verge of being forgotten that could reintroduce by the format of this project**

Target Audiences:

- Brand's fanbase
- Seasoned collectors
- Young collectors/enthusiast
- Other similar brands that went oit of business during Quartz crisis

Solution:

Presenting the brand's history through an exhibition that shows the important achievements and milestones of the brand

Execution:

**Using the existing and the remaining materials of the former brand.
Staying strictly to the former brand's personality and identity.**

For visual:

Printing archives of important events alongside with the products and description to emphasize the significance of the event. (Racing, mountain expedition, dive, sky)

Concept wall explaining the problem and the history with prominent events, figures and products.

**For physical:
Display watches: 1 land 1 dive 1 racing 1 sky**

**For digital:
Ig and Website that contains everything from the project (concept, design process, brand timeline, product collection and image library.**

Concept:

- **Bg context (brand introduction, problem)**
- **Tackling the gap of lacking of storytelling and spreading of knowledges**
- **Design execution, process**
- **Solution, exhibition**

Timeline divivded into 3 parts:

- **The predecessor and the event that marked the birth of the Sherpa**
- **World map of Sherpa events**
- **The downfall**

4 collections:

- **Land (guide)**
- **Racing (graph)**
- **Dive (ops, dive, aquagrap**
- **Sky (super jet, gmt)**